

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Farouk Saeed

Address: 22 Queens Road Belmont SM2 6BZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing as a resident of Queens Road to express my strong support for planning application DM2025/01591.

As someone who is retired and living locally, I greatly value facilities that are accessible within easy walking distance of my home. The proposed community centre would provide exactly that - a welcoming and inclusive space where residents can participate in social, educational and wellbeing activities without needing to travel far.

In retirement, opportunities for social interaction and structured community engagement become increasingly important. A local centre offering activities, talks, community support and health and wellbeing programmes would help reduce isolation, promote wellbeing and strengthen neighbourhood connections.

I also understand that some concerns have been raised about traffic and parking. In my view, the proposal is modest in scale and includes sensible measures such as on-site parking, disabled bays, cycle storage and an emphasis on sustainable travel. The use will also be managed and time-limited, with Friday prayers staggered to avoid conflict with school pick-up times, which should help ensure minimal disruption.

Overall, I believe this represents a positive and well-considered reuse of an existing building, bringing clear community benefit while remaining in keeping with the character of the local area. I do not believe it will cause significant traffic, noise or amenity issues.

I am pleased to lend my full support to the application and respectfully ask the Council to approve it.

Yours faithfully,
Farouk Saeed, MBE